(GMDP). Prof. Ramanna's proposal evoked a mixture of emotions in me.

When again would I have such an opportunity to consolidate al our knowledge of rocketry and apply it?

I felt honoured by the esteem in which Prof. Ramanna held me. He had been the guiding spirit behind the Pokharan nuclear test, and I was thril ed by the impact he had helped create on the outside world about India's technical competence. I knew I would not be able to refuse him. Prof. Ramanna advised me to talk to Prof. Dhawan on this issue so that he could work out the modalities of my transfer from ISRO to DRDL.

I met Prof. Dhawan on 14 January 1981. He gave me a patient hearing, with his typical penchant for weighing everything careful y to make sure he didn't miss a point. A markedly pleasant expression came to his face. He said, "I am pleased with their appraisal of my man's work". He then smiled. I have never met anyone with a smile quite like Prof. Dhawan's—a soft white cloud—you could picture it in any shape you wanted to.

I wondered how I should proceed. "Should I formal y apply for the post so that DRDL could send the